

DIGITALAIKART

CTET DECEMBER 2026

COUNTDOWN PLAYBOOK

The 75-day sprint plan for the 22nd Central Teacher Eligibility Test

Exam: 12th and 13th December 2026

75 DAYS

Sept 29 to exam day

2 PAPERS

Paper I and Paper II covered

90 MARKS

the line this plan takes you past

Every exam fact verified against the official CBSE / CTET Information Bulletin and public notices
Strategy, subject playbooks, mock system, and exam-day execution

DIGITAL EDITION

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PART 0

Read This First

What this playbook is, who it is for, and how to use it

On 28 September 2026 you have exactly 75 days until the 22nd Central Teacher Eligibility Test opens on 12 December. That is enough time to cross the 90-mark qualifying line comfortably, **if** you spend those days on the right things. This playbook is the plan.

Everything in it is built on two foundations. First, the facts: the exam structure, dates, qualifying rules, syllabus breakdowns and processes all come from the official CTET September 2026 Information Bulletin issued by CBSE and the public notices on ctet.nic.in, current as of late September 2026. Second, the strategy: a phase-by-phase countdown that front-loads pedagogy - the part of the paper most candidates under-prepare - and locks in exam execution through a mock-test system in the final weeks.

It is written for three kinds of reader:

- **First-timers** - B.Ed, D.El.Ed or BTC holders appearing for the first time, who need structure more than motivation.
- **Repeaters** - including the many candidates who registered in the reopened August window and now have extra time they did not expect.
- **Working aspirants** - those balancing a job or a teaching practice alongside preparation, with 3 to 4 hours a day to give.

Use it in this order. Read Parts 1 and 2 today so you understand what the exam actually rewards. Set up your Part 3 weekly plan tonight. Then work subject by subject: CDP (Part 4) is common to both papers, so start there regardless of which paper you are writing. Keep the mock system (Part 8) running from week four onwards, and read Part 9 - the exam-day protocol - twice: once in November, once in the final week.

A note on sources

Exam dates, pattern, qualifying marks, fee, validity and process details in this book are drawn from the official CTET-September 2026 Information Bulletin (CBSE) and public notices dated 25 August 2026 and 14 September 2026 on ctet.nic.in. Where a detail for the December edition has not yet been announced - for example your exact exam date and shift - this book says so and tells you when to expect it. Nothing here overrides the official bulletin; always re-check ctet.nic.in before the exam.

PART 1

The Exam You Are Actually Facing

Verified facts about the 22nd edition - and the calendar that governs your next 75 days

The 22nd edition of CTET will be conducted on **12 and 13 December 2026**. CBSE announced this in a public notice dated 14 September 2026, after an unusual year: the edition originally scheduled as the September 2026 cycle was shifted, and the application window itself was reopened from 25 August to 1 September 2026. That reopening followed a Supreme Court judgment in a review

petition that emphasised giving eligible teachers a reasonable opportunity to obtain the statutory TET qualification. The result is the situation you are in now: a national exam with lakhs of registered candidates, 75 days away, and a syllabus that has not changed.

Nothing about the shift changes what is on the paper. The pattern, syllabus and qualifying rules below are from the official bulletin. What the shift does change is your runway - and unlike the candidates who prepared for a September date, you have time to do this properly.

1.1 The countdown calendar

Mark these checkpoints on your phone today. CBSE has committed to two specific service levels before the exam, so you are not left guessing.

When	What happens	What you do
28 September (today)	75 days remain	Read Parts 1-2, set up your Part 3 plan, take one past paper cold as a diagnostic
29 September	Day 1 of the plan	Begin Phase 1: CDP foundation (Part 4 of this book)
Around 27 November	Exam city and exam date intimation (CBSE releases this 15 days before the exam)	Check the CTET portal; note your date - 12 or 13 December - and city; plan travel and stay if needed
Around 10-11 December	Admit card released (CBSE issues it 2 days before the exam)	Download immediately, verify every detail, print two copies
12-13 December	CTET 22nd edition	Run the Part 9 exam-day protocol

Do not assume your exam date. With the exam spread across two days, your allotted date and city arrive with the 15-day intimation, and CBSE does not entertain change requests. If your centre is in another city, book travel the day the intimation arrives - not in the final week, when fares and availability punish you.

1.2 What CTET is - and what it is not

CTET is a qualifying test, not a recruitment exam. It exists because Section 23(1) of the Right to Education Act requires teachers for Classes 1 to 8 to pass a Teacher Eligibility Test; NCTE set the rules in 2010-11 and the Ministry of Education entrusted the conduct of the central test to CBSE. Passing it makes you **eligible** to apply; it does not give you a job, and the bulletin says so explicitly. Recruitment - KVS, NVS, state SCERTs, DSSSB and private school hiring - is a separate process that gives weightage to CTET scores.

Where the certificate counts, per the official bulletin:

- Central government schools: Kendriya Vidyalayas, Navodaya Vidyalayas, Central Tibetan Schools and schools in the UTs of Chandigarh, Dadra and Nagar Haveli, Daman and Diu, Andaman and Nicobar, Lakshadweep, and Delhi.
- CBSE-affiliated schools: passing CTET or a state TET has been mandatory for teachers appointed since 6 March 2012.
- Unaided private schools may consider CTET at their option.

- State government and aided schools follow the state's own TET - though a state that does not conduct its own TET can choose to accept CTET.

Two properties of the certificate matter enormously to how you plan. First, **validity is now for lifetime** for all categories - once you qualify, you never need to sit the exam again unless you want a higher score. Second, **there is no limit on attempts**, and a qualified candidate may reappear purely to improve a score. Both facts push in the same direction: this attempt deserves your best 75 days, because the certificate you earn is the one you keep.

One more thing worth knowing

The certificate and marksheet are issued digitally through DigiLocker, digitally signed and carrying an encrypted QR code verifiable through the DigiLocker app - legally valid under the IT Act, with no physical copy to lose or laminate. CBSE creates the DigiLocker account from the mobile number you registered, so keep that number active.

1.3 Are you eligible to sit this edition?

CTET's minimum qualifications are laid down by NCTE, not invented by coaching centres, and CBSE checks them at recruitment, not at the exam gate - being allowed to appear never implies your eligibility has been verified. The practical rule from the bulletin: satisfy your eligibility before and for yourself, on ncte.gov.in, because the responsibility is personal. NCTE allows up to 5 per cent relaxation in the qualifying marks of the minimum educational qualification for reserved categories - SC, ST, OBC and differently-abled candidates. If you are mid-way through or just finished a B.Ed, D.El.Ed, B.El.Ed or an equivalent recognised programme, check your own qualification against the NCTE regulations rather than hearsay, and check it once, properly, this week - not after the result.

PART 2

Score Math That Should Shape Your Prep

The pattern, the 90-mark line, and why pedagogy is the single biggest scoring lever

2.1 The two papers, exactly as CBSE structures them

Both papers carry 150 multiple-choice questions worth one mark each, answered on an OMR sheet in two and a half hours. Every question has four options. **There is no negative marking** - a fact that should change how you attempt the paper, and we come back to it below.

Paper I (for classes 1 to 5):

Section	Questions	Marks
Child Development and Pedagogy (compulsory)	30	30
Language I (compulsory)	30	30
Language II (compulsory)	30	30
Mathematics (compulsory)	30	30
Environmental Studies (compulsory)	30	30
Total	150	150

Paper II (for classes 6 to 8):

Section	Questions	Marks
Child Development and Pedagogy (compulsory)	30	30
Language I (compulsory)	30	30
Language II (compulsory)	30	30
Mathematics and Science (for maths and science teachers) OR Social Studies / Social Science (for social studies teachers)	60	60
Total	150	150

In the September 2026 cycle as scheduled in the bulletin, Paper II ran in the morning from 9:30 to 12:00 and Paper I in the evening from 2:30 to 5:00, with candidates required to report two hours early. Expect a similar shift pattern in December, but treat your own admit card - released two days before the exam - as the only authority on your timing, centre and date.

You can register for one paper or both; if you teach or intend to teach across levels, both is common - the two papers run as separate shifts, morning and evening in recent cycles. CBSE will confirm your exact date and shift with the city intimation and admit card. Most of this book applies to both papers; where they differ, it says so.

2.2 The 90-mark line

Per the NCTE notification of 11 February 2011, a person scoring **60 per cent or more in TET is considered TET pass**. On a 150-mark paper that is **90 marks**. School managements may give concessions to SC, ST, OBC and differently-abled candidates according to their own reservation policies, but the published line is 90, and many recruiting bodies apply exactly that.

So your real target is not 90. Aim at **105 or better (70 per cent)** for three reasons: it absorbs a bad section or a harsh paper; recruiters that weight CTET scores reward higher marks; and a 105 in mocks means you can lose 15 marks to exam-day nerves and still clear comfortably. Throughout this book, 105 is the number the plan is built around.

2.3 The pedagogy dividend: count the marks

Here is the arithmetic most candidates never do. Every section in CTET splits into content questions and pedagogy questions - and pedagogy is the larger pool. In Paper I:

Pedagogy component	Marks
Child Development and Pedagogy (the whole section)	30
Mathematics - pedagogical issues	15
EVS - pedagogical issues	15
Language I - pedagogy of language development	15
Language II - pedagogy of language development	15
Total pedagogy marks in Paper I	90

Ninety of 150 marks in Paper I are pedagogy-flavoured - **exactly the qualifying score**. A candidate who masters pedagogy alone is already at the pass line; content knowledge is what converts a pass into a strong score. In Paper II the pedagogy pool is 70 to 80 marks depending on your subject (CDP 30, language pedagogy 15 + 15, and 10 for maths and science or 20 for social studies).

And here is the part that makes pedagogy the best investment in the syllabus: **all of it runs on one philosophy**. Whether the question sits in CDP, maths pedagogy or EVS pedagogy, the child-centred, activity-based, inclusive option is the right one with remarkable consistency. Learn the philosophy once (Part 4), and you are simultaneously preparing five different sections of the paper.

The 40 per cent rule

Across all phases of this plan, at least 40 per cent of your study time goes to solving questions - topic quizzes, past papers, mocks - not to reading. Reading pedagogy feels productive and tests nothing. From week 4 onward, raise the practice share to 60 per cent. The exam is an OMR test, not an oral exam; train the skill you will actually perform.

2.4 No negative marking: the never-blank rule

With four options, one mark per correct answer and zero penalty for a wrong one, leaving any question blank is a mathematical error. If you cannot identify the answer, eliminate what you can and mark the most child-centred remaining option; if you cannot even do that, mark anything. A blank scores 0 with certainty; a guess averages 0.25 and costs nothing. On 20 unknown questions, that difference is worth roughly five marks - often the gap between 85 and a certificate.

The same rule shapes time management. 150 questions in 150 minutes means an average of one minute per question, but you should not spend it uniformly. Sweep your strong sections fast, park anything that resists you, and reserve the last ten minutes to fill every blank on the OMR. Part 8 turns this into a drilled routine.

2.5 Paper I, Paper II, or both?

By application time this choice was already made - general and OBC candidates paid Rs 1,000 for one paper and Rs 1,200 for both (Rs 500 and Rs 600 for SC, ST and differently-abled candidates, plus GST) - but candidates second-guess the choice in October, so here is the framework. Teach Classes 1 to 5, choose Paper I. Teach Classes 6 to 8, Paper II. Want both levels, or maximum optionality across Kendriya Vidyalaya, Navodaya and state recruitments: both papers, which most serious candidates attempt on the two exam days. The two papers share CDP and both language sections; only the 60-mark subject block differs. That overlap is why repeaters convert a Paper I certificate into both far more often than fresh candidates expect - if you have prepared Paper I honestly, you are already two-thirds prepared for Paper II.

One caution if you are attempting both: prepare the subject block for the paper that matches your teaching qualification first, and add the other paper's content only from week 5. Trying to run two full subject blocks from week 1 is the classic route to two mediocre scores.

PART 3

The 75-Day Master Plan

Three phases, one weekly rhythm, and hour-by-hour templates you can start tonight

3.1 The phase map

The plan runs from Monday 29 September to the exam. It divides into three phases plus a taper, each with a single job. If you are starting late or slipping behind, compress Phase 1 - never Phase 3.

Phase	Dates	The one job	Exit condition
Phase 1 - Foundation	29 Sep - 19 Oct (weeks 1-3)	Build CDP from zero; start daily comprehension practice; first pass of NCERT content for your subject	One past paper attempted section-wise; CDP mock score 18+/30
Phase 2 - Depth	20 Oct - 16 Nov (weeks 4-7)	Subject content plus its pedagogy as one unit; past papers every two days; weekly full mock begins	Full mock at 95+; error journal running weekly
Phase 3 - Mock cycle	17 Nov - 6 Dec (weeks 8-10)	Ten or more full mocks under exam conditions; targeted revision from the error journal only	Two consecutive mocks at 105+
Taper	7 - 11 Dec	Revision from your own condensed notes; no new topics; logistics and sleep	Admit card printed, travel planned, notes down to 10 pages

The logic of the order: CDP first because it is common to both papers and feeds the pedagogy questions in every other section; languages early because comprehension accuracy grows on daily repetition, not cramming; the heavy 60-mark subject block in the middle weeks while stamina is highest; mocks last because they are a measurement instrument, not a learning method - taking them before you have something to measure wastes your best simulator.

3.2 The weekly rhythm

Every week follows the same shape, which removes the daily decision of what to study:

- **Monday to Saturday:** two blocks a day - a 60/40 split between the week's main subject and a rotating second subject (see the phase descriptions above).
- **Saturday:** one timed sectional test on the week's main subject, reviewed the same evening.
- **Sunday:** full mock in exam conditions (from week 4), then a 45-minute review, then the error journal, then rest. In weeks 1-3, Sunday is a past-paper day plus journal review.

Protect the Sunday review like a class you have paid for. The review is where marks are actually won; the mock only tells you where to dig.

3.3 Daily templates

Full-time aspirant (about 6 hours a day):

Slot	Duration	What
Morning, first 90 min	1.5 hr	New CDP or subject theory for the week's main subject, made into one-page notes as you read
Late morning	1 hr	30 MCQs on yesterday's and today's topics, from a question bank or past papers
Afternoon	2 hr	Second subject (language practice or NCERT content), alternating by day
Evening	1 hr	One unseen passage in each of your two languages, plus language pedagogy notes
Night, last 30 min	0.5 hr	Update the error journal; re-solve the errors from three days ago

Working aspirant (about 3.5 hours a day):

Slot	Duration	What
Early morning	1 hr	Main subject theory + notes (the brain before the job, not after)
Commute or lunch	30 min	20 MCQs on the phone or a printed set; comprehension passage every other day
Evening	1.5 hr	Second subject and question practice on today's theory
Night, last 30 min	0.5 hr	Error journal; flash review of the one-page notes from this week

Both templates end the day the same way on purpose: the error journal is the only component that compounds. What you write tonight and re-solve on Thursday is worth more than a fresh chapter.

3.4 The ten weeks in detail

Each week has one focus and one deliverable. If life interrupts a week, protect the deliverable and let the focus slide a day - never the reverse.

Week	Focus and deliverable
1 29 Sep - 5 Oct	CDP: child development block (development principles, heredity and environment, socialisation, Piaget). Deliverable: the week-1 diagnostic past paper, attempted section-wise, scored and logged.

Week	Focus and deliverable
2 6 - 12 Oct	CDP: Vygotsky, Kohlberg, intelligence constructs, language and thought. Deliverable: one page per theorist, each with two invented classroom examples. Start daily comprehension passages from today.
3 13 - 19 Oct	CDP: inclusive education and learning-pedagogy blocks, plus the whole language-pedagogy syllabus (it repeats across four sections). Deliverable: 30-question quizzes on each block, journal running.
4 20 - 26 Oct	Your 60-mark subject begins (Paper II) or maths-and-EVS rotation (Paper I): NCERT chapters with one-page notes plus 20-30 questions per chapter. Deliverable: first full-length Sunday mock.
5 27 Oct - 2 Nov	Subject content continues; begin subject pedagogy as part of each chapter, not as a separate later task. Deliverable: past-paper sections of your subject, two this week.
6 3 - 9 Nov	Subject depth; second pass on weak chapters identified by the journal. Deliverable: weekly mock at 95 or above.
7 10 - 16 Nov	Finish every syllabus item. Nothing remains unattempted after 16 November. Deliverable: full syllabus checklist ticked, second consecutive mock at 95+.
8 17 - 23 Nov	Mock cycle: three full mocks this week, each followed by the 45-minute analysis. Deliverable: error journal re-solve of all week-8 errors.
9 24 - 30 Nov	Mock cycle: three to four mocks; targeted revision only from journal and one-page notes. Watch the portal around 27 November for your exam city and date. Deliverable: first 105+ mock.
10 1 - 6 Dec	Final two mocks; begin converting notes toward the 10-page master sheet; logistics planned. Deliverable: two consecutive mocks at 105+.

Notice what the last three weeks contain: no new books, no new coaching material, no new topics. The finish line of preparation is earlier than candidates think - 16 November - and everything after it is sharpening. The most common December regret is a candidate still reading a fresh guide in the final week; this plan closes that door on purpose.

3.5 If you fall behind: the recovery protocol

A 75-day plan survives contact with real life only if it has a protocol for the week that collapses - illness, a family event, a work crunch. Here is the rule: never try to catch up everything. On the first day back, spend one hour updating the weekly tracker and deciding what is dropped, not what is delayed. Then apply the priority order the exam itself rewards: CDP first, language pedagogy second, your 60-mark subject third, comprehension practice continues daily regardless (it is 20 minutes), everything else last. A candidate who lost week 6 entirely and protected that order still clears 90; a candidate who tried to recover all of week 6 on top of week 7 typically loses both. One lost week costs four to six marks. Panic costs twenty.

The same protocol applies if you are reading this book in mid-October: shrink Phase 1 to one week (CDP cram sheet plus theorists), run Phase 2 fully, and never cut Phase 3. The mock cycle is the phase that converts preparation into marks; a thin foundation with a real mock cycle beats an encyclopedic foundation that never met an OMR sheet.

PART 4

Child Development and Pedagogy: The 30 Questions That Decide Both Papers

The official topic map, the theorists, and the child-centred answer test

CDP is 30 marks in Paper I and 30 marks in Paper II - same section, same syllabus, only the age context differs (6 to 11 years for Paper I, 11 to 14 for Paper II). It is also the section where preparation converts to marks fastest, because the question pool is the most predictable in the exam.

4.1 The official map

The bulletin fixes the internal split, so allocate effort in exactly these proportions:

Block	Qs	Core topics from the official syllabus
Child Development	15	Development and its link to learning; principles of development; heredity and environment; socialisation (teachers, parents, peers); Piaget, Kohlberg and Vygotsky; child-centred and progressive education; intelligence and its multi-dimensional view; language and thought; gender as a social construct; individual differences; assessment for versus of learning; CCE and school-based assessment
Inclusive Education	5	Addressing learners from diverse, disadvantaged and deprived backgrounds; children with learning difficulties and impairments; talented, creative and specially-abled learners
Learning and Pedagogy	10	How children think and learn and why they fail; learning as a social activity; the child as problem solver and scientific investigator; children's errors as significant steps; cognition and emotions; motivation; personal and environmental factors contributing to learning

4.2 The theorists, the way the exam asks them

CTET almost never asks "state Piaget's stages". It describes a classroom or a child and asks you to recognise the theory in action - which stage a seven-year-old showing symbolic play is in, what a teacher using scaffolding is doing, which moral level a rule-following child occupies. So learn each theorist as a **recognition pattern**, not a definition. One page per theorist, half theory and half classroom examples, revised weekly.

Theorist	The core idea	How the exam asks it
Piaget - cognitive development	Four stages: sensorimotor (0-2), preoperational (2-7), concrete operational (7-11), formal operational (11+). Children build schemas through assimilation and accommodation; thinking is qualitatively different at each stage.	A child of a given age does something characteristic - centration, lack of conservation, egocentrism, abstract hypothesis - and you identify the stage.
Vygotsky - social development	Learning happens through social interaction. The Zone of Proximal Development is the gap between what a child can do alone and with guidance; scaffolding is the temporary, gradually withdrawn support.	A teacher gives hints, models a skill, then steps back - identify ZPD or scaffolding. Also contrast with Piaget on language and thought (for Vygotsky, language drives thinking).
Kohlberg - moral development	Three levels - pre-conventional, conventional, post-conventional - each with two stages, from punishment-avoidance through social approval and law to universal ethical principle.	A child's reasoning about a rule or a dilemma is quoted; you classify the level. Focus on the reasoning given, not the choice made.

Theorist	The core idea	How the exam asks it
Gardner - multiple intelligences	Intelligence is multi-dimensional - linguistic, logical, spatial, musical, bodily-kinaesthetic, interpersonal, intrapersonal, naturalistic - rather than a single IQ score.	A teacher uses different modes (music, movement, group work) to reach different learners; identify the principle. Links to individual differences and the critical perspective on intelligence.

Two habits multiply the value of this table. First, for every theory write one classroom situation that exemplifies it - your own invented example, which you will remember better than any book's. Second, when you solve past papers, log which theorist each CDP question tested; you will find the same recognition patterns repeating, which is exactly what makes this section bankable.

4.3 Inclusive education: five of the easiest marks in the paper

Five questions on inclusive education appear in every paper, and the syllabus for them is short: addressing learners from diverse, disadvantaged and deprived backgrounds; children with learning difficulties and impairments; and talented, creative and specially-abled learners. Know the **inclusion versus integration** distinction cold - integration places a child in a regular classroom with the onus on the child to adjust, while inclusion redesigns the classroom so the child belongs - because the exam frames most of these questions as "what should the teacher do", and the answer is almost always the inclusive option: adapt the lesson, use varied materials, collaborate with parents and specialists, never segregate or label.

This block also connects to the RPWD Act 2016 vocabulary that CBSE itself uses in the exam's own concessions (benchmark disability, scribes, compensatory time). Read the inclusive-education syllabus twice, do 30 questions on it, and treat those five marks as already yours.

4.4 Learning and pedagogy: the ten questions on how classrooms work

The Learning and Pedagogy block rewards understanding over memory. The questions cluster around five ideas:

- **How children learn** - learning as an active, social process; the child as a problem solver and scientific investigator; why children fail (mismatch of teaching to the child, not defect in the child).
- **Errors as learning** - a child's mistakes are significant steps in the learning process, windows into thinking, to be analysed rather than punished. Expect questions where the wrong-but-kind teacher response is the trap.
- **Motivation** - intrinsic beats extrinsic; encouragement over reward-and-punishment; the learner's confidence as the teacher's responsibility.
- **Assessment** - assessment **for** learning (feedback during teaching, to improve) versus assessment **of** learning (judgement after); school-based assessment and CCE as continuous, comprehensive, covering scholastic and co-scholastic areas.
- **Factors of learning** - personal (readiness, interest, health) and environmental (classroom climate, home, peers); the teacher's job is to shape the environment.

The assessment distinction deserves one full evening: "for" versus "of" appears directly and indirectly in several questions across both papers, including inside subject-pedagogy sections.

4.5 The child-centred answer test

When a pedagogy question - in CDP, or the pedagogy half of maths, EVS, science, social studies or language - offers you four plausible actions by a teacher, run the option through these six filters, in order:

- 1 Is it **learner-centred** - does the child's thinking, interest or question drive the activity, or does the teacher's convenience drive it?
- 2 Is it **inclusive** - does it work for diverse learners in the same room, or does it quietly exclude someone?
- 3 Is it **activity- and experience-based** - does the child do, touch, discuss, discover; or only listen and copy?
- 4 Is it **constructive** - does it build on what the child already knows and believes, including using the child's own errors?
- 5 Is feedback **continuous and formative** - does the teacher find out what the child understands during learning, not only at the end?
- 6 Does it **respect the child** - no shaming, no labels, no comparison that humiliates?

The option that passes all six is the answer with striking reliability. Options that fail filters 1, 3 or 6 are the classic traps: lecture-first, teacher-centred, punishment-flavoured choices dressed in efficient-sounding language. This test is also why CDP preparation transfers to every other section - you are learning to read pedagogy questions the way their setters write them.

Practice illustration - the pattern in action

A Class 4 pupil repeatedly writes 347 as "three hundred forty-seven = $300 + 40 + 7$ " but answers place-value questions wrong. What should the teacher do first? The child-centred option is to analyse the error, understand the child's current thinking, and design a targeted activity with concrete material - not to re-explain the whole chapter, not to give more drill of the same kind, and not to move on hoping revision will fix it. The question tests error analysis and diagnostic teaching; the correct option is the one that starts from the child's actual understanding. This is the shape of pedagogy MCQs in every section.

4.6 The social fabric: socialisation, gender, individual differences

Three sub-topics inside the child-development block produce steady marks once you can name them in a question stem:

- **Socialisation** - the process by which a child absorbs the norms of the social world, with teachers, parents and peers as the three agents the syllabus names. Questions describe an agent influencing a child and ask you to identify the process or the agent.
- **Gender as a social construct** - gender roles, gender bias and educational practice. The exam rewards the option that treats gender differences as learned and changeable, and penalises the option that treats them as natural and fixed. A textbook showing women only cooking is a bias question waiting to happen.
- **Individual differences** - diversity of language, caste, gender, community and religion among learners, and the teacher's response: differentiated instruction, not uniform treatment or segregation.

4.7 Practice set: five questions in the exam's own style

Attempt these before reading the answers. Each is built on a pattern that recurs across past papers, using the official syllabus's concepts.

Question (compressed)	Answer and why
A Class 2 child says the moon is following her. The teacher should: (a) correct her immediately (b) ask the class what they think and why (c) mark it as a misconception to fix in the test (d) ignore it	(b). The preoperational child's egocentrism is normal thinking; the child-centred teacher uses it as a discussion starting point, not an error to punish.
A teacher solves a problem at the board, then gives a similar one with one step hidden and helps only where the student stalls. This illustrates: (a) conditioning (b) scaffolding within the ZPD (c) rote learning (d) drill	(b). Support that is withdrawn as competence grows is Vygotsky's scaffolding operating inside the zone of proximal development.
A student returns a lost wallet because otherwise she will be punished. Kohlberg's level: (a) post-conventional (b) conventional (c) pre-conventional (d) autonomous	(c). Reasoning driven by punishment avoidance is the pre-conventional level, stage one.
After a unit test, a teacher writes comments on each answer sheet and re-teaches the two weakest topics before moving on. This is: (a) assessment of learning (b) assessment for learning (c) norm-referenced ranking (d) scholastic grading	(b). Feedback that changes subsequent teaching is assessment FOR learning; a mark that merely certifies is assessment OF learning.
In a multilingual class, a teacher lets children explain a science idea in their home language before writing it in English. The principle: (a) translation drill (b) the multilingual classroom as a resource (c) immersion (d) remediation	(b). Home languages are a resource, not interference - the inclusive principle applied to language teaching.

Make five such cards of your own every Sunday from the week's material. By December you will have fifty, and the exam's pedagogy questions will read like old acquaintances.

4.8 The CDP cram sheet

Every term below is exam vocabulary you will meet in question stems. Each gets one line and one trigger phrase - revise this sheet in every Sunday review and rebuild it from memory once in week 9; what you cannot rebuild is what you do not yet own.

Term	One line you must be able to write	Trigger in a question
Cephalocaudal / proximodistal	Development proceeds head-to-toe and centre-to-extremities	Order questions on growth direction
Assimilation vs accommodation	Fitting new experience into an existing schema vs changing the schema to fit	A child meets something unfamiliar
Object permanence	Knowing things exist when unseen - achieved in the sensorimotor stage	Infant play scenarios
Egocentrism	Preoperational child cannot take another's viewpoint	The moon follows me - a preoperational remark
Conservation	Quantity survives change of shape - concrete operational milestone	Water poured into a different glass

Term	One line you must be able to write	Trigger in a question
Centration	Focusing on one dimension and ignoring others	The taller-thinner glass looks like more
ZPD	Gap between independent and assisted performance	Guided help that works
Scaffolding	Temporary support, withdrawn as competence grows	Teacher hints, then steps back
Moral levels (Kohlberg)	Pre-conventional, conventional, post-conventional, two stages each	Why a child follows or breaks a rule
Intrinsic motivation	Learning driven by interest, not reward or fear	Praise-the-effort options
Assessment for learning	Feedback that shapes ongoing teaching	Comments plus re-teaching
CCE / SBA	Continuous, comprehensive, school-based - scholastic and co-scholastic	Evaluation design questions
Inclusion	Redesigning the classroom so every child belongs	Any question naming a disability or deprived background
Error analysis	A child's wrong answer as diagnostic information	The misconception-bank questions of Part 6

PART 5

Language I and Language II

Sixty marks that reward steady daily practice - and a pedagogy syllabus that repeats verbatim

The two language sections look identical - 30 questions each, split 15 comprehension plus 15 pedagogy of language development - but they test different things. **Language I focuses on proficiency related to the medium of instruction; Language II focuses on the elements of language, communication and comprehension.** Language II must be a different language from Language I, chosen from the same list of 27 languages - English, Hindi and the full schedule from Assamese to Sindhi - at the time of application.

5.1 Choosing your languages

If you have already applied, this is settled; skip ahead. If you ever apply again, the working rule: choose your strongest language as Language I, and as Language II pick the language of the question papers you study best - because the main paper is bilingual Hindi-English and most coaching material assumes one of the two. The pedagogy questions are the same in every language (translated), so comprehension strength, not the language's identity, should decide.

5.2 Comprehension: fifteen marks of technique

In Language I you get two unseen passages - one prose or drama, one a poem; in Language II, two prose passages. Questions cover comprehension, inference, grammar and verbal ability. The method that works under time pressure:

- 1 Read the questions first. You are hunting specifics, not savouring literature; knowing what is asked turns the first read into an active search.

- 2 Skim the passage once at speed, then return to locate each answer precisely - for a stated fact, the exact line beats your impression.
- 3 For inference questions ("the author implies..."), prefer the option supported by the passage over the option that is true in the real world. The passage is the only universe.
- 4 For poems, expect figurative language - image, metaphor, mood - and a question on why a specific word or image was chosen.
- 5 For the verbal-ability fill-in items, read the whole sentence and check tense, agreement and idiom before marking.

Start this from day 1: one passage per language per day, from week 1 to the exam. Comprehension accuracy is a slow-cooked skill; 15 minutes daily beats three hours on Sunday. Track your accuracy in the journal like any other section.

5.3 Language pedagogy: the syllabus that repeats

The pedagogy-of-language-development block is nearly identical across Language I and Language II, and - apart from the passages - identical between papers. Its topics, straight from the official syllabus: learning versus acquisition; principles of language teaching; the role of listening and speaking and how children use language as a tool; a critical perspective on the role of grammar; challenges of teaching language in a diverse classroom, including language difficulties, errors and disorders; the four skills and how to evaluate them; teaching-learning materials from textbooks to multimedia to the multilingual resource of the classroom itself; and remedial teaching. Paper II's Language I adds IT as a tool.

Three distinctions carry most of the marks here:

- **Acquisition versus learning** - a child's effortless pickup of a first language through exposure and use (acquisition) versus formal, conscious study of a language (learning). Questions describe a child absorbing language at home versus in class and ask you to name the process.
- **The multilingual classroom as a resource** - a diverse classroom's home languages are a teaching asset, not a problem to be disciplined away. This is the inclusive-education principle wearing a language hat.
- **Grammar in context** - the modern position embeds grammar in meaningful communication rather than isolated rules; the option that has children noticing grammar inside real reading and writing beats the one that drills worksheets.

Because the syllabus repeats, your language-pedagogy notes serve four sections at once: 15 marks in Language I, 15 in Language II, and echo inside CDP's language-and-thought questions. Prepare it once, properly, in weeks 2 and 3.

5.4 Grammar and verbal ability: what the 15 comprehension marks actually contain

Inside the comprehension sections sit a handful of recurring item types. Drill them as recognisable categories rather than open-ended English practice:

Item type	What it looks like	How to attack it
Direct fact	According to the passage...	Locate the exact line; match paraphrases, not words
Inference	The author suggests or implies...	Choose the option the passage supports, however true another sounds
Vocabulary in context	The word X in line 4 most nearly means...	Substitute each option into the sentence; context beats the dictionary
Poetic device or mood	A stanza is quoted; the imagery suggests...	Name the sense the image appeals to; pick the mood word with the right charge
Grammar fill-in	A sentence with a blank	Check subject-verb agreement and tense before meaning
Rearrangement or error spotting	Parts of a sentence, or four underlined parts	Read for the subject and verb first; most errors live there

Two of every type per day, per language, is roughly ten minutes - and by week 6 these become the fastest marks on your paper.

PART 6

Paper I Subjects: Mathematics 30 and EVS 30

NCERT Classes 1-5 content, difficulty up to secondary - and 30 marks of pedagogy in each

6.1 Mathematics: 15 content, 15 pedagogy

The official content list is the whole of primary-school maths: geometry, shapes and spatial understanding, solids around us, numbers, the four operations, measurement, weight, time, volume, data handling, patterns and money - based on the NCERT syllabus for Classes 1 to 5, though the difficulty and linkages can rise to secondary level. Do not be misled by the word "primary": questions test understanding (why the algorithm works, which representation to use) as much as calculation.

The pedagogy half is where the marks concentrate for most candidates: the nature of mathematics and logical thinking; the place of mathematics in the curriculum; the language of mathematics; community mathematics; evaluation through formal and informal methods; problems of teaching; and above all **error analysis with diagnostic and remedial teaching**. A large share of maths pedagogy questions present a child's wrong answer and ask what the teacher should do - and the answer pattern is the child-centred test from Part 4: diagnose the specific misconception, address it with concrete material, then verify.

Practical allocation: two-thirds of your maths time on content until your NCERT Class 1-5 concepts and quick calculation are solid, then flip the ratio - because 15 pedagogy marks ride on skills you build once in Part 4 and apply here.

6.2 EVS: 15 content, 15 pedagogy

EVS content is organised into six themes from the official syllabus, and the exam tests the connections between them as much as the facts inside them:

Theme	What it covers
Family and Friends	Relationships, work and play, animals, plants - the web the child lives inside
Food	Sources of food, food habits, and the journey from farm to plate
Shelter	Houses and habitats across regions, materials, why homes differ
Water	Sources, uses, conservation, the water around the child's own life
Travel	Journeys, maps, directions, transport old and new
Things We Make and Do	Crafts, tools, occupations, how the made world comes to be

The pedagogy block asks about the concept and scope of EVS and why it is integrated - the deliberate merger of science and social science at the primary stage - plus learning principles, approaches to presenting concepts, activities and experimentation, discussion, CCE, teaching materials and aids, and the problems of teaching EVS. The theme questions reward a teacher who connects topics to the child's own environment - family, food, water, travel - so when in doubt, pick the option that starts from the child's lived experience.

How to study EVS efficiently

Study by theme, not by textbook chapter. Take "Water": list the concepts (sources, states, uses, scarcity, conservation, waterborne disease), attach one classroom activity to each (a water audit of the school tap, a rain-harvesting walk), and add the pedagogy vocabulary (integrated, activity-based, CCE). One theme finished like this is worth three chapters skimmed.

6.3 The misconception bank: where marks hide in maths pedagogy

Maths pedagogy questions rarely ask abstract theory; they show a child's wrong answer and ask what it reveals and what the teacher does next. The recurring misconceptions are few. Learn them as patterns with their remedies:

Child's error	What it reveals	Teacher's move
Writes 0.5 as smaller than 0.45 because 45 is bigger than 5	Whole-number thinking applied to decimals	Place-value strips and a number line; compare tenths with tenths
Computes $403 - 198$ as 295, ignoring regrouping	Procedural gap, not concept failure	Regrouping with base-ten blocks; then re-attach the algorithm to the model
Says one-fourth is bigger than one-third because 4 is bigger than 3	Whole-number bias on fraction size	Fraction bars and paper folding; reason about the unit fraction
Multiplies 12×10 as 1200	Over-generalising a pattern without sense-making	Estimation first, then verify; discuss why the pattern broke
Calls the longer row of counters more, even when the counts are equal	Piaget's conservation - appearance over quantity	One-to-one pairing activity; count both rows together

The answer to every one of these, in the exam's phrasing, is some version of: **diagnose the misconception, use concrete material, then re-visit the algorithm**. The option that says practise more sums of the same type is the trap - repetition of a broken procedure entrenches it, which is precisely what diagnostic and remedial teaching exists to avoid.

PART 7

Paper II: The 60-Mark Subject Block

Maths and Science, or Social Studies - the block that decides your total

Whichever route you chose at application, this block is 60 of your 150 marks, and it is the widest gap between candidates who prepared with NCERT and those who prepared with random notes. The official note in the bulletin is the instruction for your whole study plan: questions are based on the NCERT syllabus for Classes 6 to 8, but the difficulty standard and linkages can reach up to the senior secondary stage. Read the middle-school textbook as a teacher - the concept, the activity, the common misconception - and stretch each topic one level above where the textbook leaves it.

7.1 Mathematics and Science route

Mathematics is 30 questions - 20 content, 10 pedagogy. Content: the number system (including negative numbers and integers), fractions, an introduction to algebra, ratio and proportion, basic geometrical ideas, elementary 2-D and 3-D shapes, symmetry, constructions, mensuration and data handling. Science is also 30 questions - 20 content, 10 pedagogy - over food (sources, components, cleaning), materials of daily use, the world of the living, moving things, people and ideas, how things work (electric current and circuits, magnets), natural phenomena and natural resources.

The science pedagogy list is short and precise: the nature and structure of science, aims and objectives, understanding and appreciating science, the integrated approach, observation-experiment-discovery as the method of science, innovation, text material and aids, evaluation across the cognitive, psychomotor and affective domains, problems, and remedial teaching. Translate that into one sentence for the exam: **science is learned by doing, and the correct option is the one with the child observing, experimenting or discovering** - never the one with the teacher lecturing a finished fact.

7.2 Social Studies route

Social Studies is the biggest single block in CTET - 40 content questions plus 20 pedagogy. The content splits three ways:

- **History (from the official list):** when, where and how; the earliest societies; the first farmers and herders; the first cities and early states; new ideas; the first empire; contacts with distant lands; political developments; culture and science; new kings and kingdoms; the Sultans of Delhi; architecture; the creation of an empire; social change; regional cultures; the establishment of Company power; rural life and society; colonialism and tribal societies; the Revolt of 1857-58; women and reform; challenging the caste system; the nationalist movement; and India after independence.
- **Geography:** geography as a social study and as a science; the Earth in the solar system; the globe; the natural and human environment; air; water; settlement, transport and communication; and resources - natural and human - including agriculture.
- **Social and Political Life:** diversity; local and state government; making a living; democracy; understanding media; unpacking gender; the Constitution; parliamentary government; the judiciary; and social justice and the marginalised.

Twenty pedagogy questions then cover the concept and nature of social science, classroom processes and discourse, developing critical thinking, enquiry and empirical evidence, problems of teaching the subject, primary and secondary sources, project work, and evaluation. The source-work idea - reading a coin or a folk song as a primary source - recurs constantly, both in content and pedagogy questions; give it a dedicated study session.

7.3 The NCERT method

For either route, the preparation cycle is the same and needs no expensive material:

- 1 Read the NCERT Classes 6-8 textbooks for your subject, one chapter at a time, writing a one-page note: the concepts, the boxes and activities, and the misconception each chapter quietly corrects.
- 2 Do 20 to 30 questions per chapter from a question bank or past papers immediately, the same day - the note exists to make this practice accurate.
- 3 For every pedagogy item in the chapter (the "think and discuss" boxes), ask: what is the child-centred way to teach this? That one question is your 20-mark pedagogy preparation.
- 4 Every second day from week 4, solve one past-paper section of your subject rather than mixed quizzes - train the exact format you will face.

Chapter activities and boxed items in NCERT are not decoration - they are the exam's question bank for the pedagogy half. Candidates who read only summaries miss this entirely; you will not.

7.4 History on one page

The history list from the official syllabus runs in a single arc from prehistory to independence. Revise it as five chapters of one story, and attach each to what a Class 7 or 8 child is actually asked about it:

Era	Syllabus items	The exam angle
Prehistory to first cities	Earliest societies; first farmers and herders; first cities; early states; new ideas	Sources: what a tool, a burial or a seal tells us; why agriculture changed settlement
Ancient empires	The first empire; contacts with distant lands; political developments; culture and science	Mauryan administration; edicts as sources; trade routes and exchange
Medieval	New kings and kingdoms; Sultans of Delhi; creation of an empire; architecture; regional cultures; social change	Land and tribute relations; Sultanate and Mughal consolidation; architecture as evidence
Colonial	Establishment of Company power; rural life and society; colonialism and tribal societies; the Revolt of 1857-58; women and reform; challenging the caste system	How Company rule changed land and livelihood; 1857 as a turning point; reform movements' methods and opposition
Nationalist to now	The nationalist movement; India after independence	Different streams of the movement; the Constitution's promises; partition's costs

7.5 Geography and polity that repeat every year

A small set of geography and political-life ideas carries a large share of the block's marks because they anchor dozens of situation questions:

- The Earth in the solar system, the globe, and latitudes versus longitudes - the basis of every map question.
- Air and water: the atmosphere's layers, the water cycle, and conservation - repeatedly connected to the child's own environment, the EVS-style framing.
- Human environment: settlement types, transport and communication networks, and why they differ across regions.
- Resources - natural versus human - and agriculture as the classic case study linking both.
- Polity's ladder: diversity, then local government, then state government, then democracy and the Constitution, ending with the judiciary and social justice for the marginalised. Questions test the ladder's logic - who decides what, at which level, and why.

PART 8

The Mock System

Mocks as measurement and repair - the cadence, the analysis protocol, and the milestones

8.1 Cadence: how many, when

Past papers are the single best predictor of CTET questions - the syllabus is stable and the recognition patterns repeat. Schedule them like this:

Weeks	Practice load
1-3	Topic quizzes daily; one past paper attempted section-wise as a diagnostic in week 1
4-7	One past paper every two days, timed section by section; one full mock each Sunday
8-10	Eight to ten full-length mocks under strict exam conditions, plus re-solving your error journal between them
Taper week	Two light mocks for rhythm only; no deep analysis in the last three days

Full-length means 150 questions in 150 minutes, on a printed OMR-style answer grid, at the hour your real shift will run - morning candidates mock at 9:30, evening candidates at 2:30 - with the phone in another room. Half the value of a mock is training the clock and the bladder, not the syllabus.

8.2 The analysis protocol

A mock without analysis is entertainment. After every mock, spend 45 minutes and sort every wrong and every guessed-right answer into four buckets:

Error type	Signal	Fix
Concept gap	You did not know the fact or theory	Add to your one-page notes for that topic; re-read that section only
Misread	You knew it but answered the wrong thing (missed NOT, EXCEPT, most appropriate)	Slow down on stems; circle negative words as you read
Trap option	You were drawn to the plausible but teacher-centred or extreme option	Run the six-filter test from Part 4 on every pedagogy question

Error type	Signal	Fix
Time loss	You never reached the question	Reset per-section time budgets; practice skipping on first resistance

Every error goes into the journal with five fields: the question in short, your answer, the correct answer, why you were wrong (one line, from the table above), and the revisit date - three days later, then a week later. The journal is your most personal and most valuable study document by December; guard it.

8.3 Milestones

On past-paper difficulty, expect a trajectory like this if the plan is being followed: 75 to 85 on the week-1 diagnostic; crossing 90 by the first Sunday mock in week 4; 95 to 100 through weeks 5 to 7; 105 or better twice consecutively before the taper begins. If you are below these lines, the diagnosis is nearly always in one of two places - pedagogy questions being answered on gut feeling instead of the filters, or comprehension questions answered on impression instead of the locate-and-verify method. Fix the process, not the effort.

8.4 OMR discipline

Fill the OMR in waves - complete a section, transfer its answers in one batch of bubbling - and practise this from your very first mock. Wave-filling is fast, keeps your place, and avoids the catastrophic misalignment of one question skipped on the sheet. Reserve the final ten minutes to sweep every remaining blank; with no negative marking, the sheet you hand in must have 150 marks against it, not 141.

8.5 A worked walkthrough: what a real analysis looks like

A candidate scores 97 on a Sunday mock in week 9 - 15 above the line, 8 short of target. The 45-minute analysis reads like this: CDP 22 of 30, with all eight losses on scenario questions where the gut overrode the filters - fix: re-run the six filters on each, log as trap errors. Language I 25 of 30, with three losses on inference - fix: the locate-and-verify method slipped under time pressure; log as misreads. Language II 21 of 30, with five losses scattered across grammar - fix: one targeted grammar session on the two item types missed; log as concept gaps. Subject block 29 of 60 - the real story: eleven questions never reached in time. Fix is not study at all but the clock: skip-on-first-resistance drilled in the next two mocks. Total: 97, with an identified 14 recoverable marks and a plan attached to each. That is what an analysis is - a score is only its raw material.

PART 9

The Final Two Weeks and Exam Day

The taper, the logistics, and the 150-minute execution plan

9.1 The taper: 7 to 11 December, day by day

The last five days exist to convert knowledge into calm. Nothing new is studied in this window - if a topic is untouched by 7 December, it stays untouched; the marks it would have cost you were already banked elsewhere in the plan.

Day	Plan
Mon 7 Dec	Condense all your one-page notes into a 10-page master sheet: theorists, pedagogy filters, formulas, theme maps, grammar rules. This is your only study material from now on.
Tue 8 Dec	One light full mock in the morning at your real shift hour; light review in the evening; revise the master sheet once.
Wed 9 Dec	Error journal only - re-solve every entry from weeks 8-10. Finish with 30 minutes of your strongest subject, for confidence, not content.
Thu 10 Dec	Logistics day: download the admit card (CBSE releases it two days before the exam), verify every detail, print two copies; check the centre location and travel time; keep your photo ID ready. Revise the master sheet once. Sleep at your exam-day target time.
Fri 11 Dec	Master sheet twice, once in the morning and once by afternoon. Pack: admit card copies, ID, water, simple food, this book open to the execution plan. No mock, no new material, no late night.

9.2 Reporting, documents, and what not to carry

The bulletin's conduct rules are strict and specific, and they decide your exam before the first question does:

- Report two hours early - in the September cycle's schedule, 7:30 AM for the morning paper and 12:30 PM for the evening paper; candidates arriving after the paper starts are not admitted. Your admit card states your own reporting time for December - follow it, not memory.
- Carry the downloaded admit card and an original valid photo ID. No admit card, no exam; the rules leave no discretion.
- Leave at home: wristwatches, wallets, handbags, phones and earphones, health bands, and ornaments - gold or artificial. The list is explicit in the conduct procedure, and frisking is thorough.
- Biometric authentication may be used at centres; arriving inside the reporting window keeps it painless.
- PwBD candidates entitled to a scribe or compensatory time (50 minutes) must carry the original disability certificate or UDID card in the prescribed form, or the facility is refused on the spot.

9.3 The 150-minute execution plan

This is the sequence to rehearse in every mock from week 8, so that on exam day it runs itself:

Minutes	Action
0 - 5	Read the instructions, check the paper code against your OMR, fill your details once and calmly
5 - 25	Your stronger language section - warm, fast, accurate
25 - 55	CDP while your mind is freshest - run every pedagogy question through the six filters
55 - 75	Your second language
75 - 140	The subject block (Paper I: maths then EVS; Paper II: your 60-mark block) - skip on first resistance, park and return
140 - 150	The blank sweep: every parked and unknown question gets a mark; verify the OMR has 150 entries and no misalignment

If you are writing both papers, the between-shifts protocol matters as much as either paper: eat something simple, drink water, do not discuss the morning paper with anyone, and put your mind in the evening starting box. A post-mortem between shifts is the cheapest way to lose the second paper before it begins.

Night-before checklist (11 December)

Admit card printed twice and details verified. Original photo ID kept with it. Centre location and travel time checked; alarm set well before reporting time. Clothes without forbidden items; no watch, no ornaments. Simple food and water arranged. Master sheet revised once; this book open to the execution plan. Sleep at the target hour - seven to eight hours: a rested brain beats one more chapter in every study ever conducted on the question.

9.4 The exam morning, hour by hour

- 1 Wake at least three hours before your shift - your brain needs one full cycle to reach working temperature; eat something familiar and light.
- 2 Leave with time to spare for the one thing you cannot control on the day: traffic. The two-hour early reporting window in the conduct rules is your friend, not a suggestion.
- 3 At the gate, expect frisking and possibly biometric verification; keep the admit card in your hand, not the bottom of a bag, and keep your ID with it.
- 4 Inside, take your allotted seat, check the paper code on the question paper against your OMR, and fill your details once, calmly, before the clock starts mattering.
- 5 When the paper begins, execute the rehearsed sequence - you have run it ten times by now; today it simply counts.

Between the two shifts, if you are a both-papers candidate: simple food, water, a fifteen-minute walk if the campus allows it, and no discussion of the morning paper with anyone - not one sentence. The evening paper deserves the same fresh mind the morning one got.

PART 10

After the Exam

The answer-key window, the result, and what a lifetime certificate actually unlocks

10.1 The answer-key window

After the exam, CBSE displays the scanned OMR answer sheets and the answer keys on ctet.nic.in, announcing the window by public notice - historically only two to three days. If you are confident a question's official key is wrong, you can challenge it online with a processing fee of **Rs 1,000 per question**, refunded if your challenge is upheld by the subject experts. Check the site daily in the week after your exam; the window closes on its stated date, and challenges by email or post are not considered. The final answer keys, after challenges, are what the result is computed on.

10.2 Your OMR copy

After the result, you may request the photocopy of your OMR answer sheet along with the calculation sheet by paying **Rs 500 per OMR** by demand draft. There is no re-evaluation or re-checking of CTET results - that door does not exist - so if your score lands near the line, the OMR copy is the only verification you can get. Note that OMR records are weeded out two months after the result declaration; act within that window.

10.3 Result and certificate

The result of the previous (21st) edition came out roughly seven weeks after the exam, so watch ctet.nic.in from late January. If you have scored 90 or above, CBSE issues your marksheet and eligibility certificate digitally through DigiLocker - digitally signed, QR-verifiable, legally valid - with the account created on your registered mobile number. The certificate's validity is lifetime for all categories, and you can reappear in any future edition purely to improve your score, since there is no cap on attempts.

10.4 What comes next

A CTET certificate makes you eligible; it does not employ you. The recruitment cycle is separate, and the recruiting body - KVS, NVS, an EMRS, a state SCERT, a municipal body like DSSSB, or a private school - runs its own selection process, in which CTET scores carry weightage as the bulletin notes. The practical sequence after your result: keep the DigiLocker certificate safe; track recruitment notifications for the schools you want, which typically specify CTET qualification and your paper; and prepare for those recruitment exams using the same machinery you built in these 75 days - the error journal, the phase discipline, the child-centred reading of every pedagogy question.

You will notice, in December, that the habit mattered more than the syllabus. That habit is yours to keep.

PART 11

The Mistakes That Cost Certificates

Ten failure patterns from past CTET cycles - and the fix for each

Every point below is a pattern that reliably separates candidates who score 88 from candidates who score 104 on the same preparation. Read this list now, and again on 1 December.

- 1 **Treating pedagogy as one section among five.** Pedagogy carries 90 of 150 marks in Paper I. Prepare it as the spine of the paper, not a 30-question side dish.
- 2 **Reading instead of solving.** If less than 40 per cent of your study time produces pencil marks on questions, you are rehearsing reading, not testing.
- 3 **Collecting books.** NCERT textbooks, one standard CDP text and ten years of past papers are sufficient. Material accumulation is anxiety wearing a study costume.
- 4 **Mocks without analysis.** A score without a diagnosis is trivia. The 45-minute post-mock review is where the marks are manufactured.

- 5 **No error journal.** A mistake corrected twice becomes a habit; a mistake unlogged becomes a routine.
- 6 **Starting new topics in the last week.** After 7 December, new input displaces retrieval practice - the exact skill the exam needs. The taper is sacred.
- 7 **Leaving blanks on the OMR.** With no negative marking, every blank is a donation of expected marks. Ten unfilled questions cost more than most candidates' entire gap to 90.
- 8 **Ignoring the languages.** Sixty marks across two sections treated as an afterthought by many. One passage a day per language from week 1 is the entire cost of avoiding this.
- 9 **Gut-feeling pedagogy answers.** The six filters exist because plausibility is engineered into the wrong options. When torn, filter - do not guess on vibes.
- 10 **Neglecting logistics.** Reporting late, a missing ID, or a watch on the wrist has ended real candidatures. The logistics day is part of preparation, not a break from it.

The one-line summary of this book

Spend the next ten weeks making pedagogy your own, practising daily with a journal, and rehearsing the exam-day plan in ten honest mocks - and the 90-mark line will not be the moment of drama you fear, but a checkpoint you pass on the way to 105.

PART A

Official Sources

Every exam fact in this playbook, and where it comes from

All exam-related facts in this playbook are drawn from these official documents, as available in late September 2026. Verify anything time-sensitive directly on the portals before acting on it.

Source	What it verifies in this book
ctet.nic.in - official CTET portal	Notices, application windows, admit card and city-intimation timing, answer keys, results
CTET September 2026 Information Bulletin, CBSE	Exam pattern, section-wise question split, syllabus, qualifying marks, validity, fee, conduct rules, DigiLocker certificates, challenge process
CBSE public notice dated 25 August 2026	Reopened application window (25 Aug - 1 Sep 2026) and the Supreme Court review petition context
CBSE public notice dated 14 September 2026	22nd edition exam dates: 12 and 13 December 2026; city intimation 15 days before; admit card two days before
ncte.gov.in - NCTE	Minimum qualifications for teacher eligibility (verify your own eligibility here)

This playbook is an independent preparation guide. It is not published by CBSE, CTET or NCTE, and nothing in it replaces the official bulletin, your admit card, or the notices on ctet.nic.in.

PART B

The Weekly Tracker

Print this, stick it where you study, and fill it every Sunday

Ten weeks, one line each. Fill the mock column honestly - the trend, not any single number, is the information.

Week	Dates (2026)	Focus	Sunday mock	Notes
1	29 Sep - 5 Oct	CDP foundation + diagnostic	-	
2	6 - 12 Oct	CDP + comprehension daily	-	
3	13 - 19 Oct	CDP + language pedagogy	-	
4	20 - 26 Oct	Subject content begins + first full mock		
5	27 Oct - 2 Nov	Subject + pedagogy as one unit		
6	3 - 9 Nov	Subject depth + past papers		
7	10 - 16 Nov	Finish syllabus; weekly mock		
8	17 - 23 Nov	Mock cycle + journal		
9	24 - 30 Nov	Mock cycle + journal (city intimation due around 27 Nov)		
10	1 - 6 Dec	Final mocks; two at 105+		
Taper	7 - 11 Dec	Master sheet + logistics + sleep	-	
Exam	12 - 13 Dec	Run the plan	-	

Seventy-five days is enough. Start tonight.

PART C

The Free Official Toolkit

Everything you genuinely need that costs nothing

Before buying anything else for this exam, know what the official ecosystem already gives you. Your Rs 99 went to strategy and organisation; the raw material below is free:

Resource	Where	Use it for
CTET portal	ctet.nic.in	Public notices, admit card, city intimation, answer keys, results, the Information Bulletin itself
CTET question papers and final answer keys	Published on ctet.nic.in after each edition	Past papers - the single best practice material that exists for this exam
NCERT textbooks (Classes 1-8)	ncert.nic.in - free PDFs of every textbook	The content backbone for every section, both papers
NCTE portal	ncte.gov.in	Eligibility regulations and teacher-qualification notifications
DigiLocker	digilocker.gov.in	Where your digital marksheet and certificate will arrive, QR-verified

A question bank with explanations is the one purchase that earns its price, and even that is optional if you work through past papers with the analysis discipline of Part 8. Coaching videos, prediction papers and telegram channels add noise, not marks; the plan in this book plus the free material above is a complete preparation.

PART D

The Whole Syllabus as a Checklist

Both papers, every topic, from the official Appendix I - tick as you master

Paper I (classes 1 to 5):

- **CDP (30):** concept of development and its relationship with learning; principles of development; heredity and environment; socialisation - the social world of teacher, parents and peers; Piaget, Kohlberg and Vygotsky; child-centred and progressive education; critical perspective on intelligence; multi-dimensional intelligence; language and thought; gender as a social construct, gender roles, bias and educational practice; individual differences across language, caste, gender, community and religion; assessment for versus of learning; school-based assessment and CCE; formulating questions that assess readiness and build critical thinking. Inclusive education (5): diverse, disadvantaged and deprived backgrounds; learning difficulties and impairments; talented, creative and specially-abled learners. Learning and pedagogy (10): how children think and learn and why they fail; basic processes of teaching and learning; learning as a social activity; the child as problem solver and scientific investigator; children's errors as significant steps; cognition and emotions; motivation; personal and environmental factors.
- **Mathematics (30):** content (15) - geometry, shapes and spatial understanding, solids around us, numbers, addition and subtraction, multiplication, division, measurement, weight, time, volume, data handling, patterns, money. Pedagogy (15) - nature of mathematics and logical thinking, place in the curriculum, language of mathematics, community mathematics, evaluation through formal and informal methods, problems of teaching, error analysis, diagnostic and remedial teaching.
- **EVS (30):** content (15) - family and friends (relationships, work and play, animals, plants), food, shelter, water, travel, things we make and do. Pedagogy (15) - concept and scope of EVS, significance, integrated EVS, environmental studies versus environmental education, learning principles, relation to science and social science, approaches to presenting concepts, activities, experimentation and practical work, discussion, CCE, teaching materials and aids, problems.
- **Language I (30):** comprehension (15) - two unseen passages, one prose or drama and one poem, with questions on comprehension, inference, grammar and verbal ability. Pedagogy (15) - learning and acquisition, principles of language teaching, role of listening and speaking, critical perspective on grammar's role, challenges of the diverse classroom, language difficulties, errors and disorders, the four skills and their evaluation, teaching-learning materials, remedial teaching.
- **Language II (30):** comprehension (15) - two unseen prose passages. Pedagogy (15) - the same list as Language I.

Paper II (classes 6 to 8):

- **CDP (30):** identical syllabus to Paper I, contextualised to ages 11 to 14.
- **Language I and Language II (30 each):** the same comprehension-plus-pedagogy structure; Language I adds IT as a tool.
- **Mathematics (30, for the maths and science route):** content (20) - number system (knowing our numbers, playing with numbers, whole numbers, negative numbers and integers, fractions), introduction to algebra, ratio and proportion, basic geometrical ideas, elementary 2-D and 3-D shapes, symmetry, constructions, mensuration, data handling. Pedagogy (10) - nature of mathematics and logical thinking, place in the curriculum, language of mathematics, community mathematics, evaluation, remedial teaching, problems of teaching.
- **Science (30, for the maths and science route):** content (20) - food (sources, components, cleaning), materials of daily use, the world of the living, moving things, people and ideas, how things work (electric current and circuits, magnets), natural phenomena, natural resources. Pedagogy (10) - nature and structure of science, aims and objectives, understanding and appreciating science, integrated approach, observation-experiment-discovery, innovation, text material and aids, evaluation across cognitive, psychomotor and affective domains, problems, remedial teaching.
- **Social studies / social science (60, for the social studies route):** content (40) - history from the earliest societies to India after independence (the full arc in Part 7 of this book); geography - the Earth in the solar system, the globe, environment, air, water, settlement, transport and communication, resources and agriculture; social and political life - diversity, government at local and state level, making a living, democracy, understanding media, unpacking gender, the Constitution, parliamentary government, the judiciary, social justice and the marginalised. Pedagogy (20) - concept and nature of social science, classroom processes and discourse, developing critical thinking, enquiry and empirical evidence, problems of teaching, primary and secondary sources, project work, evaluation.

Tick each block only when you can clear a 25-question quiz on it - not when you have read it. Reading is input; the exam pays only for output.